(U) DATA ITEM DESCRIPTION (DID)

(U) Title: SYSTEM KEY MANAGEMENT PLAN (SKMP)

(U) Number: DI-MISC-82515
(U) AMSC Number: 10629
(U) DTIC Applicable: No
(U) Preparing Activity: NRO
(U) Applicable Forms: N/A
(U) Approval Date: 20260312
(U) Limitation:
(U) GIDEP Applicable: No
(U) Project Number: Misc-2026-001

I. (U) USE/RELATIONSHIP:

A. (U) PURPOSE: The System Key Management Plan (SKMP) is used by the NRO to facilitate key material ordering from the National Security Agency (NSA) and provisioning of that keying material to the Contractor. This is accomplished by identifying the cryptographic equipment used by the system and defining the specific key material required.

B. (U) The SKMP further describes the use and control of cryptographic products and services used by a cryptographic application (cryptographic engine, cryptographic module, or End Cryptographic Unit (ECU), or system) throughout its lifetime. The SKMP also identifies and documents the capabilities that the cryptographic application requires from the current and planned key management infrastructure.

C. (U) The optional SKMP Annex 1, *Cryptographic Security Plan* (CSP) will be prepared IAW and as directed in the DD Form 1423. When its completion is directed, this Annex describes the protection and recovery measures put in place for any cryptographic equipment, components, or keying material that may come into contact with or be operated in the presence of unauthorized personnel during the system's life cycle or due to failed launch.

D. (U) **Note:** The SKMP shall be approved and accepted by the Government at least 90 calendar days prior to any transfer of operational key to the Contractor. Upon acceptance by the NRO, the SKMP shall be maintained current throughout the complete program lifecycle.

II. (U) REQUIREMENTS:

A. (U) Reference Documents. In assembling the SKMP, the Contractor shall be broadly familiar with the reference document cited below (available from NRO/COMM/CPO/CSMD):

a) (U) National Reconnaissance Office, *Preparation of Communications Security (COMSEC) Program Deliverables: Guidance for NRO Program Offices and Industry Partners* (current version)

B. (U) Compliance Documents. In assembling the SKMP, the Contractor shall demonstrate, describe its approach for, and maintain compliance with each document cited below (available from NRO/COMM/CPO/CSMD).

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a) (U) National Reconnaissance Office, *NRO Communications Security Manual, Volume 1: The NRO Communications Security (COMSEC) Program* (current version)

b) (U) National Reconnaissance Office, *NRO Communications Security Manual, Volume 2: COMSEC Material Management for NRO COMSEC Responsible Officers (CRO)* (current version)

c) (U) National Reconnaissance Office Acquisition Manual (NAM) Clause, *Information Technology, Information Assurance, and Information Management Requirements* (NAM 52.204-011) (current version)

III. (U) FORMAT. The SKMP shall minimally contain narrative content, diagrams, and technical detail addressing each of the topics delineated in the following major sections and subsections. Provide Data using the electronic preparation instructions below.

1. (U) INTRODUCTION
- 1.1 (U) Document Overview
- 1.2 (U) System Overview
- 1.3 (U) Referenced Documents
- 1.4 (U) Government Documents
- 1.5 (U) Non-Government Documents

2. (U) ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS

3. (U) KEY AND CERTIFICATE MANAGEMENT PLAN PROCESS
- 3.1 (U) Cryptographic Application Description and Security Services
- 3.2 (U) Description/Purpose of Cryptographic Application
- 3.3 (U) Level of Information the Cryptographic Application is Protecting
- 3.4 (U) Security Services the Cryptographic Application Provides
  - 3.4.1 (U) Confidentiality
  - 3.4.2 (U) Integrity
  - 3.4.3 (U) Non-repudiation
  - 3.4.4 (U) Access Control
  - 3.4.5 (U) Identification and Authentication
  - 3.4.6 (U) Availability
- 3.5 (U) Operational Environment
- 3.6 (U) Requirement for Allied/Coalition Interoperability
- 3.7 (U) Key Management Products and Services Requirements
  - 3.7.1 (U) Key Management Products and Service Types
  - 3.7.2 (U) Quantity/ECU to be Keyed
  - 3.7.3 (U) Projected Quantity of ECUs
  - 3.7.4 (U) Algorithms
  - 3.7.5 (U) Key Specification
  - 3.7.6 (U) Protective Techniques
  - 3.7.7 (U) Key Period

4. (U) SKMP ANNEX 1-*Cryptographic Security Plan* (CSP) [WHEN DIRECTED]

1. (U) INTRODUCTION
- 1.1 (U) Annex Overview
- 1.2 (U) System Overview
- 1.3 (U) Program Reference Documents (Government and/or Non-Government)

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1.4 (U) Program Compliance Documents (Government and/or Non-Government)

2. (U) ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS

3. (U) PROGRAM CRYPTOGRAPHIC SECURITY PLAN

3.1 (U) Description of Program Lifecycle (Schedule, Milestones, and Overlay of Same to Sections 3.2 – 3.10, below)
3.2 (U) Protection Measures: Cryptographic Equipment
3.3 (U) Recovery Measures: Cryptographic Equipment
3.4 (U) Protection Measures: Associated Components
3.5 (U) Recovery Measures: Associated Components
3.6 (U) Protection Measures: Keying Material
3.7 (U) Recovery Measures: Keying Material
3.8 (U) Description of Protection Measures: Access Control Procedures for Authorized Personnel
3.9 (U) Description of Protection Measures: Control / Prevention of Access by Unauthorized Personnel
3.10 (U) Description of Protection Measures: Action Plan for Failed Launch
3.11 (U) Description of Protection Measures: Action Plan for Deorbiting of Space Platform
3.12 (U) Contractor’s Declaration of Implementation of Program Compliance Documents
3.13 (U) Contractor’s Estimation of CSP Sufficiency and Assessment of Residual Risk

5. (U) SKMP/SKMP ANNEX 1 COMPLIANCE MATRIX

(U) The SKMP and Annex 1 (when directed) detailed in Section II, above, shall contain (either in the body of the document, or as an attachment to it) a complete Compliance Matrix that identifies where each line item is addressed in the SKMP. The “Requirement Met?” column (D) will be completed by the Government during its review.

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(U) SYSTEM KEY MANAGEMENT PLAN (SKMP) COMPLIANCE MATRIX			
A	B	C	D
Item #	(U) Required Narrative / Technical Description	(U) Where Described in SKMP (page & paragraph #)	(U) Requirement Met?
1	(U) Describe key material management for command, telemetry, cross, and mission data links, including tactical key distribution or Over-the-Air Rekeying (OTAR) if applicable.		
2	(U) Describe the keying scheme(s) for each cryptosystem, including proposed use and handling of Black Key, if any.		
3	(U) Describe and specify the management of all keys distributed and employed from point of generation to destruction through all phases of the system lifecycle.		
4	(U) Describe and specify Space Vehicle (SV) integration and test phase locations.		
5	(U) Describe prime and subordinates (prime and subcontractors) requirements for COMSEC materials for subsystem development activities.		
6	(U) Describe any use of COMSEC materials in development, Integration & Test, simulators, launch support, and operations, as applicable.		
7	(U) Describe planned or sustained use of program COMSEC material at Factory during operations.		
8	(U) Describe closeout of Factory COMSEC material, post-launch.		
9	(U) Describe Space Ground assets/build out at factory sites and operational locations.		
10	(U) Develop and provide an Annex that specifies the actual launch configuration of all COMSEC equipment and key assigned to each link.		
11	(U) Develop and provide an Annex that specifies all program locations/assets used at system fly out to enable the System Operations organization to identify all system resources in use that require disposition.		
12	(U) Describe the “as flown” assignment of key editions and flight equipment to each satellite.		
13	(U) Describe the COMSEC architecture of the program.		

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14	(U) Describe where, as a part thereof or separately, a COMSEC Operations and Constraints and/or On-Console Contingency Plan is maintained.		
15	(U) Describe how the SKMP is maintained under configuration control.		
16	(U) Describe the mission, number of satellites, and overview of the communications architecture.		
17	(U) Provide a master schedule with project equipment, key delivery need-by dates, quantities, and delivery locations, referenced to the system development milestones, including projected launch dates.		
18	(U) Provide an overview of the different communication links the system will employ to include the links that will need cryptographic security and the classification level of the data for each link.		
19	(U) If applicable: Provide an overview, description, and CONOPS for handling and transfer of Black Key (overall) and Black Key rekey processes, to prevent the inadvertent transfer of collocated Red Key from the COMSEC Material Control System or a fill device, to an unapproved information system.		
20	(U) Provide a top-level architectural diagram (typically OV-1) illustrating how the links are interrelated with the ground stations and satellites.		
21	(U) Describe how the command uplink(s) and authentication, the telemetry downlink(s), the mission downlinks, and the crosslinks, will be employed in the system to include identification of the Aerospace Vehicle Equipment (AVE) and Ground Operating Equipment (GOE) to the link(s).		
22	(U) Describe all the various system units that will require key material for both AVE and GOE command links.		
23	(U) Describe cryptoperiods, to include estimations of mission/satellite life expectancies, in order to determine the time length for use of each unique variable before switching variables.		
24	(U) Describe the types and quantities of chips, modules, AVE and GOE for the uplink to include redundant strings, configurations and spares.		

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25	(U) Describe key formats specified for each type of key/location needed, (e.g. floppy disk, PROM, electronic) to include how many unique variables on the key media for each type/link.		
26	(U) Describe and identify key generation process/lead times, including need dates to support schedules for each development phase.		
27	(U) Provide a list of COMSEC Program compliance and reference publications, regulations, instructions, and manuals utilized in development of the SKMP. This listing shall minimally include regulations government key duplication, production, storage, repair and replacement, destruction, identification and control tracking systems, inspections, compromise, and loss in relationship to key material.		
28	(U) Identify and describe the Controlling Authority for COMSEC material accountability and prescribed usage.		
29	(U) Describe all supported cryptographic modes (e.g., bypass, secure, others) to include specific links requiring bypass.		
30	(U) Describe link loss and recovery scenarios.		
31	(U) Describe key indexing times, to include key edition switching times for normal operations and compromise, loss, or equipment failure.		
32	(U) Describe system tests requiring test, and test plans for each.		
33	(U) Describe transportation procedures for keyed embedded devices in SVs, either within the SKMP, or by reference to a Transportation Plan.		
(U) End of SKMP Compliance Matrix			

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(U) SKMP ANNEX 1-CRYPTOGRAPHIC SECURITY PLAN (CSP) COMPLIANCE MATRIX			
A	**B**	**C**	**D**
Item #	**(U) Required Narrative / Technical Description**	**(U) Where Described in Contractor's SKMP (page & paragraph #)**	**(U) Requirement Met?**
1	(U) System Overview		
2	(U) Description of Program Lifecycle (Schedule, Milestones, and Overlay)		
3	(U) Protection Measures: Cryptographic Equipment		
4	(U) Recovery Measures: Cryptographic Equipment		
5	(U) Protection Measures: Associated Components		
6	(U) Recovery Measures: Associated Components		
7	(U) Protection Measures: Keying Material		
8	(U) Recovery Measures: Keying Material		
9	(U) Description of Protection Measures: Access Control Procedures for Authorized Personnel		
10	(U) Description of Protection Measures: Control / Prevention of Access by Unauthorized Personnel		
11	(U) Description of Protection Measures: Action Plan for Failed Launch		
12	(U) Description of Protection Measures: Action Plan for Deorbiting of Space Platform		
13	(U) Contractor's Declaration of Implementation of Program Compliance Documents		
14	(U) Contractor's Estimation of CSP Sufficiency and Assessment of Residual Risk		
(U) End of SKMP Annex 1 CSP Compliance Matrix			

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